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விவசாயத் திணைக்களம்
Department of Agriculture

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நெல் ஆராய்ச்சி அபிவிருத்தி நிறுவனம் - பதலகொட
Rice Research and Development Institute (RRDI) - Bathalagoda

Dry-bed method

Nursery

Nursery location

- Developed in a place other than the prospective rice field.
    - should be about 1/10 of area to be transplanted.
    - should not be a shady place.
    - adequate irrigation facilities should be available.

Construction of the seed bed

- Seed beds of convenient dimensions are prepared by raising the soil to a height of about 5-10 cm.
- A thin layer of half burnt paddy husk could be distributed on the nursery bed mainly to facilitate uprooting.

Nursery maintenance

- Nursery should be maintained
    - without any moisture stress.
- A **basal fertilizer mixture** could be applied and incorporated between rows if the soil nutrient supply is low.
- These nurseries could be raised even during heavy rain which is not possible with **wet-bed**.

Seed Paddy

Requirement

- About 150 kg/ha.
- Higher than the requirement for **wet-bed** (as the germination could be lower).

Seed preparation

- Dry or just sprouted seeds are used.

Nursery establishment

- Seeds are sown in rows
    - Each row would be about 10cm apart from each other.
- Seeds could also be sown randomly.
    - Weed control is difficult.
    - Therefore, this method is discouraged.

- Seedlings could be uprooted at **15 – 21 days** after sowing.
    - seedlings are short and strong, has longer root system.
    - root system may get damaged during uprooting.
    - upland nurseries may get infected with **blast** and prone to pests (rodents).

This method is used when multiple varieties are grown, each in small quantities. Therefore, it is most popular with researchers.